

The New York Times Best Sellers

Adult Best Sellers in Fiction and Nonfiction in 2025

Number of Authors

425

Number of Books

467

By Sophia Pappalardo

The data included in all visualizations was collected from individual Adult New York Times Best Seller lists created in 2025. You can [click here](#) to view the source. The data was originally contained in 52 individual PDF's. I wrote a function in R to convert them into a singular data frame which I used subsets of in the figures I produced. The phrase "top book" refers to the book with the most total weeks on the list in 2025 for each category.

Figure 1 shows the distribution of the number of books on the list and how many total weeks they were on the list in 2025. The individual bars show the proportion of books that are Fiction or Nonfiction that were on the list for that value of total weeks

Figure 2 takes a closer look at the books in the Nonfiction and Fiction categories that spent the most weeks on the list in 2025. The Nonfiction category contains 12 books because in the tenth spot there are three book each with an equivalent total of 11 weeks. In Fiction, Rebecca Yarros has three books that were one of the top ten books of 2025. As pointed out in both Figure 1 and Figure 2, the top book in Nonfiction is The Anxious Generation by Jonathan Haidt and the top book in Fiction is Onyx Storm by Rebecca Yarros.

Figure 2 Comparison of Books With Most Total Weeks on The New York Times Best Seller List Between Nonfiction and Fiction

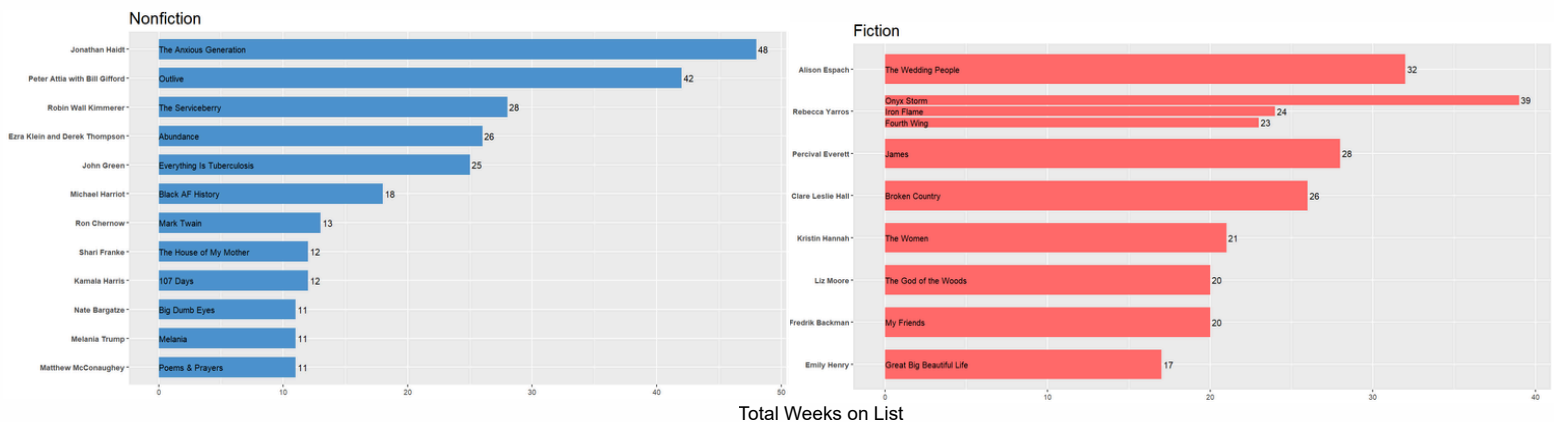


Figure 3 follows the trends of the top nonfiction and fiction book over the year as their positions on each of their lists changes. The Anxious Generation by Jonathan Haidt was published on March 26, 2024 and was on the list for each release in 2025 except for four weeks in November (11-9, 11-16, 11-23, 11-30). Onyx Storm by Rebecca Yarros was published on January 21, 2025 and its first appearance on the list was on February 9, 2025. There were a total of 8 weeks that the book was not on the list in 2025 (10-12, 11-2, 11-16, 11-23, 11-30, 12-7, 12-21, 12-28).

Figure 3

The Top Books in Fiction and Nonfiction Started at Higher Positions on the List Early in the Year
Positions range from 1-15 for each category

